

This month's takeaway question

The question comes from one of our readers, Sindoo. Here is a small code snippet, where `getObject()` is a method that returns an object of some class created with the "new" operator:

```
void* temp = getObject();
if(temp)
{
    delete temp;
    temp = NULL;
}
```

This code shows that the 'delete' called on a `void*` does not know the type of the object. What would happen in this case?

My 'must-read book' for this month

This month's 'must-read book' is actually not a single book, but a series of columns from the C++ guru, Herb Sutter, titled 'Effective Concurrency', published in Dr Dobbs programming journal. These articles are available from Sutter's Web page <http://www.gotw.ca/publications/index.htm>; look for articles titled 'Effective Concurrency'. In fact,

I would recommend all of Herb Sutter's articles, if you want to be an effective programmer.

If you have a favourite programming book that you think is a must-read for every programmer, please do send me a note with the book's name, and a short write-up on why you think it is useful, so I can mention it in this column. This would help many readers who want to improve their coding skills.

If you have any favourite programming puzzles that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at sandyasm_AT_yahoo_DOT_com. Till we meet again next month, happy programming and here's wishing you the very best! 

By: Sandya Mannarswamy

The author is an expert in systems software, and works at Hewlett-Packard India. Her interests include compilers, virtualisation technologies and software-development tools. If you are preparing for systems software interviews, you may find it useful to visit Sandya's website <http://www.tech-pathshala.com>, which offers 'practice interviews' and training for systems software jobs. Or subscribe to her Google SMS channel, <http://labs.google.co.in/smschannels/subscribe/tech-pathshala>.

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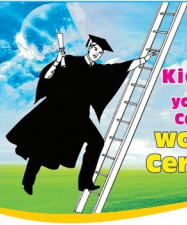


Core skills like kernel programming or Linux device drivers should be learned at a slow and steady pace for fully comprehending it, says Mr. Raghu Bharadwaj, a lead trainer on core Linux programming. Unlike normal application software learning where it is mostly restricted to functionality based learning, system programming involves deep understanding and analysis of issues like the Linux kernel and its subsystems. Your options to learn these skills are classroom based training, learning through experience, self learning through trial and error and through an effective online course.

While all other modes of training has its own merits and demerits, online learning is definitely a step ahead, especially for courses like this. Online courses gives you the comfort of accessing it 24x7 and lets you learn things during hours of focus and interest. Another important aspect is that it permits you to go through each session any number of times and fully understand each and every topic effectively.

Mr. Raghu Bharadwaj is a lead trainer at Veda Solutions, you can listen to his **training videos** on Linux kernel and device drivers at www.techveda.org

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